

Three Days in Tokyo

Tokyo has no center; think of it instead as several cities that vaguely orbit the Imperial Palace and are connected by the Yamanote Line railway. The main places visitors gravitate to are Ginza/Marunouchi, Roppongi, Shibuya/Omotesando/Harajuku, Shinjuku, Ikebukuro, Ueno, Akihabara, and Odaiba, but there are many more areas to explore.

DAY ONE Visit the **Tsukiji fish market** at the crack of dawn and breakfast at one of its famous sushi bars. From there head to **Ginza** for shopping, before moving on to the vast **Imperial Palace** complex and gardens. End the day amid the liquid crystal lights of **Shinjuku**.

DAY TWO **Shibuya**, **Harajuku**, and **Omotesando** are great for watching the best-dressed people in the world go about their business. If all the Gothic Lolita/Hello Kitty craziness gets too much, take a break amid the green spaces of **Yoyogi Park**.

DAY THREE If there is a tournament on, head to **Ryugoku** to see some sumo. For a final retail splurge, go to **Tokyo Midtown** in **Roppongi**, a vast and elegant mall with great restaurants, shops, and galleries.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Two international **airports** serve Tokyo: Narita (an hour-and-a-half north of the city by **bus** or **Metro**) and Haneda (40 minutes south of the city by **monorail** or **bus**). Tokyo has a peerless network of **subways** and overground **trains**.

WHERE TO STAY

The Welcome Inn (inexpensive) has several traditional Japanese *ryokans* (inns) that are a good deal in an expensive city. www.itcj.jp/eng
Citadines Shinjuku (moderate) is reasonably central, modern, and spacious, at a fair price. www.citadines.com

The Mandarin Oriental (expensive) has stunning views, gorgeous rooms, and great restaurants. www.mandarinoriental.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.seejapan.co.uk



Right A sushi bar at breakfast time at Tsukiji fish market, where around almost 3 tons (2,700 kg) of fish is auctioned every day

Below The busy Shinjuku district boasts Tokyo's largest concentration of skyscrapers

